

to you. You have to figure out if that attracts you because that is something you have to take very seriously. But I think that management is an exciting vector because it is a people-involving skill. It can be time consuming and draining, but it is rewarding as well.

But even if you move over to management, it doesn't mean that you forget technology. Because, as a manager, if a project is running behind and you have to make a decision, you need to be able to look at the pros and cons, analyse it and then make a call. You can't do that if you're completely detached from the technology. You really need to be connected with the technology, regardless of hardware or software. You need to know enough so that you can dial up and down.

There is a lot of talk about work-life balance getting disrupted. Are there any initiatives at your end to make sure work-life balance is not compromised? And then how do you handle the fact that somebody wants to get into the flow and forget the number of hours they are working? Do you leave it to the individual?

I believe that work-life balance starts with enjoying your work. I think that if the workplace is a fun place to be, you are not frustrated because you enjoy what you're doing and don't carry that back home. That, to me, is foundational. You need to make sure that you're in an organisation that allows that, and we certainly strive to do that. The workplace needs to be a fun place. People should enjoy the people they are working with.

There's also the element of modulating the number of work hours, which is an important aspect of work-life balance, and I think that there is a level to which the company plays a role in determining that, especially in terms of how they distribute the workload and plan projects. It is a collective partnership between the company and the individual.

If the project needs the input of five people but the company squeezes in only two people to do it, then that obviously is a problem right from the design stage. Any project or development you do always has some uncertainties that you cannot plan for. There is always a discovery based learning, which is important to recognise in the planning phase. You never know what might happen when you're doing something new, and when that hits you may have to spend more hours. I have also been in similar situations where I've hit a

roadblock while I'm in the middle of a project and spent weekends or pulled all-nighters to get around it.

But the point is, do you let that become a habit? If yes, then that will not work out well.

As a company, you need to figure out how to give certain teams a little bit of breather if it went through a rough patch. First, you need to be appreciative of their efforts and not act like you expect them to do that.

Also, there's always some discovery based learning that can come out depending on the kind of project you are working on. So, you need to be

THE TECHNOLOGY INDUSTRY IS HIGHLY COMPETITIVE. YOU COME UP WITH SOMETHING AND YOUR COMPETITOR MAY COME UP WITH SOMETHING BETTER. THIS FACTOR WILL ALWAYS REMAIN, BUT IT IS IMPORTANT THAT YOU DO NOT LET IT DICTATE YOUR WHOLE LIFE.

aware of that right before you begin and then plan accordingly so that in the planning stage itself you're taking it into account.

Even if you do the best, you'll always hit road bumps. You may also face new challenges which might require you to accelerate on your schedule. But if you keep an eye on the teams that are going through these stress times, you have to again come back to the lessons learnt and plan better next time.

Also, with most employees working from home, you have to be aware of things like the challenges one faces when a couple are both working and have a kid who is not going to school. If you are aware of that, which we at Silicon Labs are, you'll be mindful of not calling meetings during lunch hours and also be mindful of how many hours of calls you have.

In terms of one's own time management, I think a personal aspect that

is important is how you modulate your time with your family and friends. My advice is to always take out time for the things that you enjoy doing outside work. You may not be married or have kids right now, but you will, at some point in the future. So, you must get into the discipline of modulating your time well, because sometimes you get into a flow when you are enjoying your work.

There are little tweaks you can make in your schedule like taking a break once every four or six months.

The technology industry is highly competitive. You come up with something and your competitor may come up with something better. This factor will always remain, but it is important that you do not let it dictate your whole life.

My hope is that when the pandemic is over and kids are back in school, we will still have some level of flexible work-from-home options. I see that as a part of work-life balance too. If someone is not productive in the morning as they have to take care of their kid but are more productive in the evening, then I believe that they should have the flexibility to work then. So, I hope that we can have a mechanism where if somebody says that they work better in the morning, we can ensure that they can finish work in the morning instead of staying in the office till 6PM and grinding their way through the traffic. We're always about getting the work done and empowering you to manage your time.

What made you opt for this role and the accompanying challenge?

Silicon Labs is uniquely positioned to disrupt the industry as these 'not so simple' wireless end nodes leverage AI and machine learning to become more intelligent (and powerful) over time. And history is on our side. After all, technology disruptions typically occur from the bottom up, as detailed in the famous book *Innovator's Dilemma*. We are only limited by our imagination, as the saying goes, and I consider myself fortunate to be part of this incredible journey of disruption where Silicon Labs is right at the forefront.

The Hyderabad development centre is Silicon Labs' fastest-growing site, playing an important and strategic role in helping the company as a whole to meet the huge demand for Silicon Labs' solutions.

I am excited about the challenge I have set for myself to build a world-class development centre here that embodies Silicon Labs' culture and engineering best practices, with a highly motivated